

VA BDD Claim Preparation Tool

A Python CLI application to help veterans prepare Benefits Delivery at Discharge (BDD) disability claims with maximum rating potential under **38 CFR Part 4**.

What This Tool Does

Feature	Details
BDD Eligibility Check	Calculates whether you qualify (90–180 day window), filing deadlines, C&P exam deadlines
Condition Intake	Guided symptom interviews for all 38 CFR Part 4 body systems
Secondary Conditions	Flags conditions that can be claimed as secondary to primary conditions
Combined Rating Calculator	38 CFR § 4.25 whole-person math + bilateral factor (§ 4.26)
TDIU Screening	Flags eligibility for Total Disability based on Individual Unemployability
AI Language Generation	Claude API generates 38 CFR-aligned claim language for 526EZ
Nexus Letter Frameworks	Ready-to-sign templates for treating physicians
C&P Exam Prep Sheet	Condition-by-condition exam preparation guide
PDF Claim Package	Complete printable document bundle
Encrypted Local Storage	All PII/PHI encrypted with AES via PBKDF2 — nothing leaves your computer

Setup

Requirements

- Python 3.9 or higher
- An Anthropic API key (for AI language generation — optional but strongly recommended)
- ~50MB disk space

Installation

```
# 1. Navigate to the tool directory
cd va_bdd_tool

# 2. Run setup verification (installs all dependencies)
python setup.py

# 3. Set your Anthropic API key (optional — for AI features)
# Mac / Linux:
export ANTHROPIC_API_KEY='your-key-here'

# Windows:
set ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=your-key-here

# 4. Launch the tool
python main.py
```

Manual Dependency Install

```
pip install rich cryptography anthropic reportlab questionnaire python-dateutil
```

Usage

First Launch

1. The tool will ask where to store your encrypted data (default: `~/.va_bdd_tool/`)
2. You create a password — this encrypts all your claim data locally
3. **Write this password down** — there is no recovery mechanism by design

Workflow

Main Menu

- └─ Start New Claim
 - | └─ Step 1: BDD Eligibility Check
 - | | └─ Branch, dates, separation timeline, deadlines
 - | └─ Step 2: Condition Selection
 - | | └─ Select body systems (musculoskeletal, mental health, etc.)
 - | | └─ Select specific conditions within each system
 - | └─ Step 2a: Secondary Conditions
 - | | └─ Prompted automatically based on primary conditions
 - | └─ Step 3: Symptom Documentation
 - | | └─ Guided interview per condition
 - | | └─ Rating criteria displayed for reference
 - | | └─ Key measurements
 - | | └─ Functional impact
 - | | └─ In-service nexus events
 - | └─ Step 4: Rating Calculation
 - | | └─ Combined rating (38 CFR § 4.25)
 - | | └─ Bilateral factor (§ 4.26)
 - | | └─ TDIU screening (§ 4.16)
 - | | └─ Monthly compensation estimate
 - | └─ Step 5: AI Language Generation
 - | | └─ 526EZ claim language per condition
 - | | └─ Review / Edit / Regenerate interface
 - | | └─ Nexus letter frameworks
 - | | └─ C&P exam preparation guide
 - | └─ Step 6: Document Generation
 - | | └─ VA_BDD_Claim_Summary.txt
 - | | └─ VA_526EZ_Language.txt
 - | | └─ CP_Exam_Prep_Sheet.txt
 - | | └─ Nexus_Letter_Frameworks.txt
 - | | └─ Rating_Calculation_Summary.txt
 - | | └─ VA_BDD_Complete_Claim_Package.pdf
- └─ Resume Saved Claim
- └─ Rating Calculator (standalone)
- └─ Generate Output Documents
- └─ Settings
 - | └─ Export to plain text (for VSO)
 - | └─ Clear all data

Conditions Covered

Musculoskeletal (38 CFR § 4.71a)

- Lumbosacral Strain (DC 5237) — Lower Back
- Cervical Strain (DC 5237) — Neck
- Knee Conditions (DC 5260) — Left/Right with bilateral factor
- Shoulder Conditions (DC 5201) — Left/Right with dominant arm rating
- Plantar Fasciitis / Pes Planus (DC 5276) — Left/Right

Mental Health (38 CFR § 4.130)

- PTSD (DC 9411)
- Major Depressive Disorder (DC 9434)
- Generalized Anxiety Disorder (DC 9400)
- Traumatic Brain Injury (DC 8045)

Audiology (38 CFR § 4.85–4.87)

- Tinnitus (DC 6260)
- Sensorineural Hearing Loss (DC 6100)

Respiratory (38 CFR § 4.97)

- Obstructive Sleep Apnea (DC 6847)

Cardiovascular (38 CFR § 4.104)

- Hypertension (DC 7101)

Skin (38 CFR § 4.118)

- Dermatitis/Eczema (DC 7806)

Genitourinary (38 CFR § 4.115b)

- Erectile Dysfunction (DC 7522) — 0% + SMC(k)

Neurological (38 CFR § 4.124a)

- Migraine Headaches (DC 8100)
- Peripheral Neuropathy (DC 8515)

Digestive (38 CFR § 4.114)

- Irritable Bowel Syndrome (DC 7319)
-

Security & Privacy

Protection	Implementation
Encryption	AES-128 via Fernet symmetric encryption
Key Derivation	PBKDF2-SHA256, 480,000 iterations (NIST standard)
Storage	SQLite database, encrypted fields
Permissions	Directory: <code>chmod 700</code>
Network	No data sent to servers except Claude API during AI generation
AI Generation	Only symptom data sent to Anthropic API — no SSN, DOB, or identifying info required

What is sent to the Claude API?

Only the following is transmitted when you use AI language generation:

- Condition name and diagnostic code
- Your symptom descriptions (as you entered them)
- Service branch and MOS
- 38 CFR rating criteria for context

Your name, SSN, DOB, and other identifying information are **never** required by or sent to the API.

Output File Security

All output files are created with `chmod 600` (owner read/write only). They contain Protected Health Information (PHI).

Recommended handling:

- Store on an encrypted drive

- Do not email without encryption
 - Share only with: your VSO, accredited claims agent, or VA personnel
 - Shred physical copies when no longer needed
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Legal Notice

This tool is a **preparation aid only**. It is not legal advice, medical advice, or an official VA product. Final disability ratings are determined by VA adjudicators based on C&P exam findings and all available evidence.

Always consult a VSO before filing:

- DAV (Disabled American Veterans): dav.org
 - VFW: vfw.org
 - American Legion: legion.org
 - AMVETS: amvets.org
 - Find a VSO: va.gov/decision-reviews/get-help-with-review-request/
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Project Structure

```
va_bdd_tool/
├── main.py           # Entry point, main workflow orchestration
├── setup.py          # Installation verification
├── requirements.txt   # Python dependencies
├── README.md         # This file
├── modules/
│   ├── eligibility.py # BDD eligibility checker & deadline calculator
│   ├── condition_intake.py # Symptom interview & rating estimation
│   ├── rating_engine.py # 38 CFR § 4.25 combined ratings math
│   ├── ai_language.py  # Claude API integration for claim language
│   ├── secure_storage.py # Encrypted local storage (Fernet/PBKDF2)
│   └── outputs.py      # Document generation (TXT + PDF)
└── data/
    └── conditions_db.py # 38 CFR Part 4 conditions database
```

Extending the Tool

To add new conditions:

1. Add an entry to `data/conditions_db.py` following the existing schema
2. Add the condition key to the appropriate body system in `BODY_SYSTEMS`
3. Add secondary condition prompts to `SECONDARY_PROMPTS` if applicable

The rating criteria, DBQ questions, exam tips, and nexus tips are all data-driven — no code changes required for new conditions.

Built to serve those who served.